

Case 12: Launch It or Shelve It?

Domain: Sales and Marketing | Decision Archetype: Go/No-Go Decision | Framework: TAM-SAM-SOM + Launch Readiness

Scene: A small conference room, whiteboard covered in marker notes, five days before the planned launch date.

The Orbit Mobile product team stood around the whiteboard, coffee cups scattered across the table. Their new feature — an in-app "Family Data Pooling" tool letting multiple family members share one data plan — had been in testing for six weeks. Launch was scheduled for Monday.

"We can't keep debating this in circles," said the product lead, uncapping a marker. "Let's just put everything up and decide."

She drew two columns.

On the whiteboard — "What's Working":

- Beta testers (2,000 users) rated the feature 4.3/5
- 61% of beta testers said they'd recommend it to family members
- Technical testing showed no major bugs in the last two weeks
- Competitor still doesn't have this feature

On the whiteboard — "What's Worrying":

- Only 22% of beta testers actually used the pooling feature more than once — most tried it and didn't return
- Customer support flagged confusion around how billing splits between family members
- Marketing hasn't finished the explainer video — currently only 40% ready
- Legal is still reviewing how shared billing works for tax/invoice purposes in a few states

The room was split. Engineering felt ready. Marketing said they needed two more weeks. The product lead had to submit her recommendation to leadership by end of day — launch as planned, delay two weeks, or shelve the feature until next quarter.

Exhibit 1 — Market Sizing (Simplified)

	Estimate
Orbit Mobile's total user base	3.4 crore

Users with 2+ family members also on Orbit (potential market)	68 lakh
Beta-tested realistic adopters in Year 1 (5-8% of potential)	3.4 – 5.4 lakh

Exhibit 2 — Launch Readiness Snapshot

Area	Status
Product/Tech	Ready
Customer Feedback (Beta)	Mixed — liked but low repeat usage
Marketing Materials	Only 40% ready
Legal/Billing Clarity	Still under review in some states

Discussion Questions

1. Should Orbit Mobile launch on Monday as planned, delay two weeks, or shelve the feature?
2. Is the low repeat-usage number in beta testing a big enough concern to stop the launch?
3. If you were the product lead, what would you tell leadership by end of day?